



US Hwy 169 Corridor Coalition

Working together to enhance safety, reduce congestion and maximize economic development along the US Highway 169 inter-regional corridor.

To: US Hwy 169 Corridor Coalition Executive Committee

From: Technical Committee Members

Date: February 9, 2011

Re: **Project Evaluation**

INTRODUCTION:

The US Hwy 169 Corridor Coalition Board directed the Technical Committee to create a tool to be used to evaluate the identified projects along the 169 corridor. Not all projects are created equal; some are shovel ready, some require one or more studies, and some are right-of-way acquisition projects. With the evaluation matrix, the Technical Committee attempted to measure each project based on its contribution to the overall corridor goals and benefits. With this assessment, the Corridor Coalition Board can review which projects should be supported as funds become available.

EVALUATION CRITERIA:

Each project was ranked on its consistency with the corridor goals, and on the benefits the project brings to the entire Highway 169 corridor. Scoring is based on a scale of 1-3, with 1 as the lowest rank and 3 as the highest.

There are three corridor goals: Improve Traffic Safety, Improve Mobility and Reduce Congestion, and Economic Development. We were able to obtain empirical data in each of the categories, such as crash data, traffic counts, and project timing.

Corridor benefits include Local Access/Circulation, Regional Access/Circulation and Local Support. Scoring in these categories was more subjective, since there is not specific data to measure. However, the Technical Team scored each project based on our knowledge of the project and the region. We also received input from local agencies and MnDOT.

The third segment of the matrix is a description of project readiness. The matrix recognizes that each of the projects may be in a different phase of development. Some have had multiple studies and preliminary plans completed, while others recognize the need for further study. There is no ranking in this segment; rather, the matrix identifies where the project stands.

Finally, the matrix identifies the development stage of each project. Again, there is no ranking in this section. The matrix simply identifies the stage.

The attached Evaluation Matrix Key provides greater detail in each of the categories.

EVALUATION SUMMARY:

The attached matrix identifies the scores for each project. A project with a total score of 10 or less has little or no technical merit. All of the projects on our list score well above ten.

Of the 18 projects on the list, 7 scored more than 20 points. Two of the highest scoring projects (169/494 interchange and 69/169 interchange) have been funded. Six of the 18 projects had scores of 18 and 19 points, and the remaining 5 all scored above 14. Based on these scores, the Technical Committee concluded all of the projects have merit. The lower scoring projects tend to be the longer range projects.

The real value of the evaluation matrix is that it positions the Corridor Coalition and its partners to be ready to take advantage of funding opportunities for all of the projects. Generally, there are limited funding sources for projects of the magnitude along the 169 corridor. The matrix allows the Corridor Coalition to steer those limited resources towards the higher scoring projects. The matrix also allows the Corridor Coalition to provide support to local jurisdictions for projects where additional funding may become available.

ADDITIONAL DISCUSSION

As a result of the evaluation exercise, the Technical Committee realized there are other projects that do not fit into our matrix. For example, low cost/high benefit projects, managed lane projects, bus rapid transit (BRT), and rail projects, among others, will benefit the corridor. However, these projects are presently not included in any MnDOT plans. The Technical Committee recommends the Corridor Coalition Board discuss these types of projects as a question of general policy. The Corridor Coalition will then have the opportunity to comment and participate in any future discussions as they arise.

REQUESTED BOARD ACTION:

The Board should review the Evaluation Matrix and either a) accept the evaluation for use by the Coalition as provided or b) provide the Technical Committee with comments or additional direction regarding the evaluation.

ATTACHMENTS:

1. List of Technical Committee Members
2. Evaluation Matrix Key
3. Project Map
4. Evaluation Matrix



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TECHNICAL TEAM MEMBERS

Ronda Allis, Region 9 Development Commission

Joe Duncan, Bolton & Menk

Alan Forsberg, Blue Earth County

Lisa Freese, Scott County

Jim Gates, City of Bloomington

Lewis Giesking, City of St. Peter

Jane Kansier, City of Prior Lake

Michael Leek, City of Shakopee

Brandi Popenhagen, WSB

Ed Shukle, City of Jordan

Lezlie Vermillion, Scott County

Doug Weiszhaar, WSB - Corridor Advocate



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EVALUATION MATRIX KEY

CORRIDOR GOALS

Each project will be evaluated on its consistency with the four corridor goals, listed below. The ranking criterion is listed below each goal. Scoring is based on a scale of 1-3, with 1 as the lowest rank and 3 as the highest.

1. **Improve Traffic Safety:** Increase safety by reducing the number of traffic-related deaths and serious injuries, or the conditions that may cause crashes and injuries. Measurements include:
 - a. Crash rates
 - b. Signal removal consistent with IRC
 - c. Future risk (cross street traffic volumes)Data used to make these determinations will include traffic counts at key intersections, crash data, signal count, and intersection and access point inventory.
2. **Improve Mobility and Reduce Congestion:** Improve capacity and reduce congestion through key investments that:
 - a. Reduce bottlenecks
 - b. Reduce conflicts
3. **Economic Development:** Promote projects that balance access and other improvements with economic and regional goals. Maximum points are given to projects that are likely to promote development and job creation in the short, medium or long term. Scoring is based on the following:
 - a. Short term (5-10 years) – 3 points
 - b. Medium term (10-20 years) – 2 points
 - c. Long term (20 years and beyond) – 1 point

CORRIDOR BENEFITS

Each project will be scored on the overall benefit it brings to the entire US Highway 169 corridor. Scoring is based on a scale of 1-3, with 1 as the lowest rank and 3 as the highest.

1. **Local Access/Circulation:** The project will improve circulation within the areas adjacent to the US Highway 169 corridor; i.e., better access points, turn lanes, frontage roads, etc.

2. **Regional Access/Circulation:** The project improves or enhances access to economic development areas within the larger region not necessarily directly adjacent to but served by the US Highway 169 corridor.
3. **Local Support:** Plans have been approved by the local governing body (City Council, County Board). 3 = Yes, 2 = Depends, 1 = No.

TOTAL

Each project will be assigned a total value, equal to the total points assigned in each of the above criteria.

DESCRIPTION OF PROJECT READINESS

Each of the projects may be in a different phase of development. Some have had multiple studies and preliminary plans completed, while others recognize the need for further study.

1. **Transportation Studies:** Transportation studies are Complete (C), In Progress (I), or Not Started (N).
2. **Environmental Review:** Environmental studies are Complete (C), In Progress (I), or Not Started (N).
3. **Right-Of-Way:** Identify whether the project utilizes existing right-of-way (E), or in which the right-of-way has been acquired (A), or officially mapped (O), or must still be acquired (N).
4. **Funding:** Identify if project funding has been programmed in a CIP or TIP (Yes, No, or Partial).
5. **Project Status:** Evaluate the status of the project.

S = Shovel ready

P = Preliminary construction plans have been prepared

N = One or more studies required

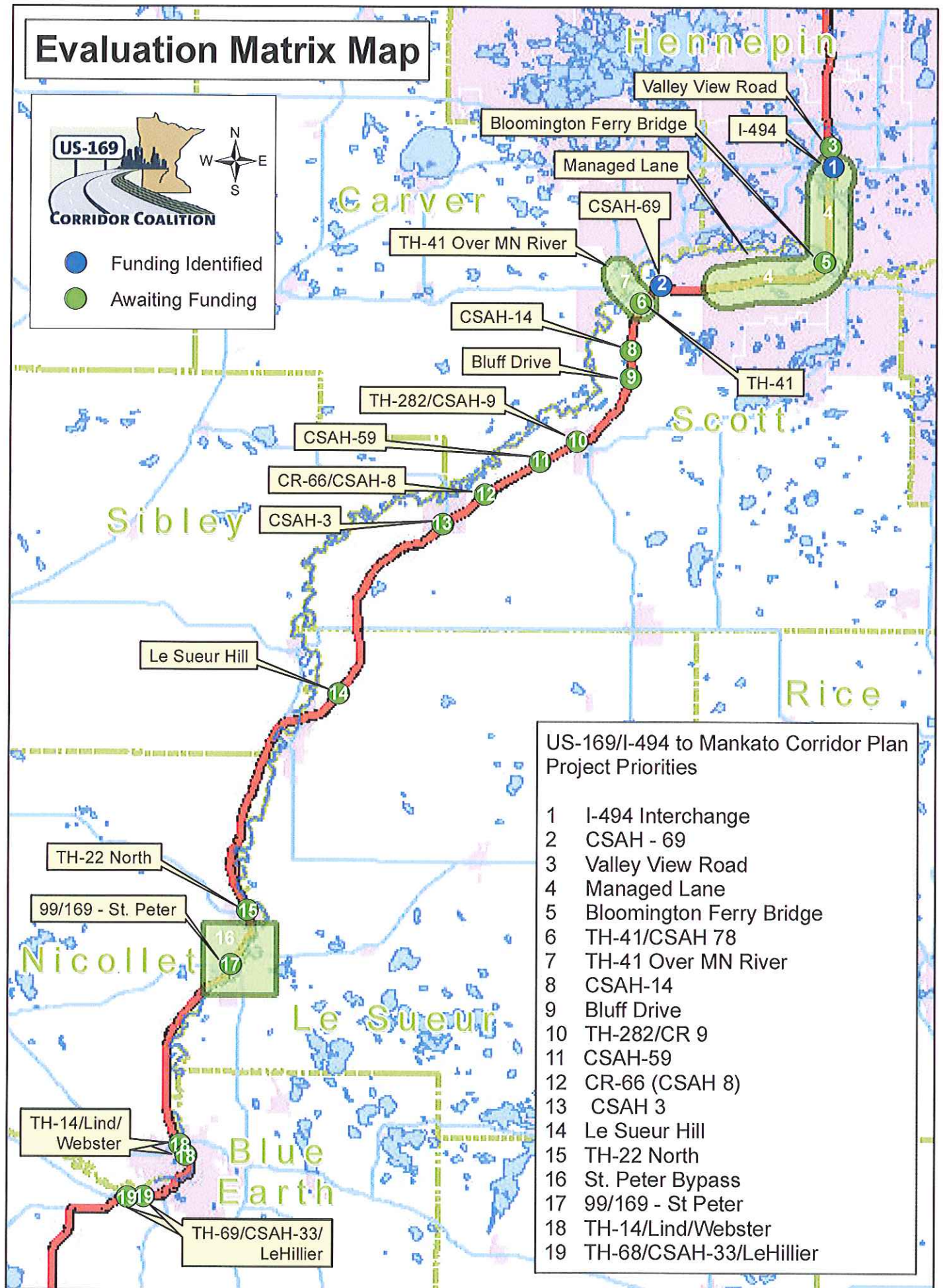
DEVELOPMENT STAGE

There are 3 types of projects: Construction, Study, or Right-of-way acquisition. The matrix attempts to recognize each of these projects is at a different stage in the overall development process. Projects will be identified as one of the three categories.

Evaluation Matrix Map



- Funding Identified
- Awaiting Funding



US-169/I-494 to Mankato Corridor Plan Project Priorities

- 1 I-494 Interchange
- 2 CSAH - 69
- 3 Valley View Road
- 4 Managed Lane
- 5 Bloomington Ferry Bridge
- 6 TH-41/CSAH 78
- 7 TH-41 Over MN River
- 8 CSAH-14
- 9 Bluff Drive
- 10 TH-282/CR 9
- 11 CSAH-59
- 12 CR-66 (CSAH 8)
- 13 CSAH 3
- 14 Le Sueur Hill
- 15 TH-22 North
- 16 St. Peter Bypass
- 17 99/169 - St Peter
- 18 TH-14/Lind/Webster
- 19 TH-68/CSAH-33/LeHillier

Evaluation Matrix
2/8/2011

Project Reference No.	Projects						Project Readiness					Development Stage			
	Route	Description	MN DOT District	Project Location	Estimated Cost (millions)	TOTAL POINTS ALL CATEGORIES									
							Transportation Studies	Environmental Review	Right-Of-Way	Funding	Project Status	Construction Project	Study Project	ROW Acquisition	Additional Comments
1	US 169/I-494	Interchange	Metro	Hennepin Co, Bloomington, Edina, Eden Prairie	\$150	27	C	C	C	C	S	X			Funded by MnDOT and TAB; project awarded in 2010, construction begins in 2011 and completed in 2012
2	CSAH 69	Interchange	Metro	Scott County, Shakopee	\$15.4	27	I	I	E	Y	P	X			Selected by MnDOT for SaM funding \$12.1 Million, Remaining funding for interchange from County/City, Access Closures on SB TH169 may require frontage road construction
3	Valley View Road		Metro	Hennepin County, Edina	TBD	22	N	I	N	N	P		X		MnDOT and Cities will reevaluate after the completion of I494/TH169 interchange is completed to determine project need based on new traffic patterns
4	US Highway 169	Managed Lane	Metro	Hennepin Co, Scott Co.	\$97.5	17	C	N	E	N	N		X	X	US 169 is a Tier 3 recommended MnPASS project, with additional study need to evaluate bridge needs/costs
5	Bloomington Ferry Bridge	Increase traffic capacity on bridge	7	Hennepin Co, Scott Co	TBD	24	I	N	E	N	N		X		Bridge designed to be expanded for extra lanes or LRT. It is congested for 1-2 hours in am peak. Engineering Feasibility Study needed to determine costs.
6	TH 41/CSAH 78	New interchange	Metro	Scott County	\$45.0	26	I	N	N	N	N		X		Intersection improved in 2005 with a project expected to have a 20 year life. TH41 river crossing Alignment decision effects interchange location and configurations. Preliminary Design should be initiated within 5-7 years
7	TH 41	MN River Crossing	Metro	Scott County, Carver County	\$500.0	19	I	I	N	N	N			X	Final EIS yet to be approved. Preferred alignment identified. River Crossing Implementation Collaborative (RCIC) working alignment issues. Funding not identified in 2030 plan. Corridor Preservation needed
8	CSAH 14	New interchange	Metro	Scott County	\$31.0	18	C	N	N	N	N		X		Concept study report prepared in 2003 and official map layout prepared, but not adopted. Twp completed a Frontage Road study. Funding Need to complete Frontage Roads.
9	Bluff Drive	Interchange or overpass	Metro	Scott County, Jordan	TBD	14	N	N	N	N	N		X		Concept study report prepared in 2003 and official map layout prepared, but not adopted.
10	TH 282/CR 9	New interchange	Metro	Jordan, Scott County	\$45.0	25	I	N	N	N	N		X	X	Preliminary Design initiated but a preferred alternative decision needed. Further study required.
11	CSAH 59	New interchange	Metro	Scott County	\$25.6	16	C	N	N	N	N		X		Concept study report prepared in 2003 and official map layout prepared, but not adopted.
12	CR 66 (CSAH 8)	Interchange	Metro	Scott County	\$3.0	14	N	N	N	N	N		X		Scott County completed the CH8 east west alignment study favoring the TH25/CH64 interchange for acces to TH169 supporting overpass option.
13	CSAH 3	Overpass	Metro	Scott County, Belle Plaine	\$6.0	19	C	N	A,O	P	P	X			City and County Completed a study that recommended an overpass, with interim access provided to TH169. Scott County programmed \$650,000 in anticipation of a City led project in its 2011-2020 TIP
14	LeSueur Hill	New interchange	7	LeSueur County, LeSueur	\$9.6	18	C	N	N	N	N	X		X	
15	TH 22 North	New Interchange	7	Nicollet County, St. Peter	\$11.2	19		N	N	Y	N				MN DOT is preparing an at-grade intersection improvement at TH 22 North in 2015. No study required.
16	St. Peter Bypass	Bypass	7	Nicollet County, St. Peter	\$47.9	19	N	N	N	N	N		X		Includes 22S/99W interchange
17	TH 14/Lind/Webster	Replace traffic signals with interchanges and grade separated crossings and construct frontage roads	7	Blue Earth Co, Nicollet Co, Mankato, No. Mankato	\$58.0	27	I	N	N	N	N	X	X	X	
18	TH 68/CSAH 33/LeHillier	Reconfigure or remove the at-grade crossings and replace with overpasses or interchanges	7	Blue Earth County	\$37.0-\$44.0	17									Made short term improvements. Not looking to conduct further projects at this time.